

Marco Carenza

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EDUCATION

New York University (NYU), New York, Brooklyn

MASTER OF FINE ARTS Game Design

SEP 2025 - MAY 2027

St. John's University, New York, Queens

MASTER OF SCIENCE Cyber and Information Security,

SEP 2022 - MAY 2024

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE Cyber Security Systems

SEP 2019 - MAY 2023

RELATED COURSEWORK

Game Design-

- Created **analog game projects & studied fundamental ideas** like rules and play, meaningful choice, feedback loops.
- **Developed creative production skills**, including prototyping, playtesting and iterating, communication and documentation, what motivates people to play and what they find fun or meaningful.
- **Learned to productively work together to make something new & communicate ideas.** Using visuals and text to clearly present concepts and designs.

Game Production Practicum-

- Efficiently and effectively **managing the realization of a creative vision as a completed game.** Articulating goals, estimating time and resources, efficient documentation, and working with project 'stakeholders'.
- **Improving metadevelopment skills** using a larger project as the occasion to refine their project and product management skills. Using tools such as **Miro, Jira, Trello.**

Game Studio 1 & 2-

- Produced **several different kinds of digital games** by working on a series of five game development projects, over the course of four months. Developing skills of designing smaller scale projects, giving and receiving critical design feedback.
- Produced a **larger game over the course of four months.** Applying a production process such as '**scrum**' in the context of a team project. **Learned technical processes of digital game development**, by rolling together elements of visual art and design, sound design, systems design, interaction design and code, into a single digital game project.

PROJECTS

Frozen Heart-

Feb 2026 - May 2026

- **Led 3 person student group** by helping concepting, delivery, and scope of the project.
- Facilitated brainstorming, communication between team members, and project roadmap.
- **Lead programmer, producer, designer.** Implementing **all gameplay features, level design** and **enemy AI.**

Gears of War Fan TTRPG-

November 2024 - May 2025

- Solo designed an unofficial **Tabletop Roleplaying Game** based on the Gears of War franchise (Xbox Game Studios).
- Designed from the ground up to **emulate the video game experience** in tabletop format.
- Developed **interlocking systems** to enhance the gameplay experience through **mechanics and progression.**
- Utilized **numerical analysis** and **data interpretation** to accurately assess dice success probabilities.

Ball Brawl-

September 2024 - May 2025

- **Local Multiplayer 2D platform fighter game.**
- Solo project in development using **Unreal Engine 5 scripting.**
- Character **controller, physics-based objects,** and **UI** implementation.

Beyond Bounds (CERN Project)-

February 2024 - June 2024

- Creation of a **scientifically accurate board game** related to **space travel.**
- Part of the "**Design the Future**" initiative at **CERN, Geneva.** Encourages **critical and order of magnitude thinking.**
- Held the **leadership position** in designing the experience in accordance with CERN's DNA.

SKILLS

- **Unreal Engine 5** (scripting) & **Unity & Godot.**
- Production tools (**Miro, Jira, Trello, MS Excel**)
- Ability to write technical **documentation** (Game Design Documents, one-pagers, reports, analysis...).
- **Level & System Design.**
- **Prototyping & Testing** (using design tools and in engine).
- **Mechanics & Interactions, Quest & Narrative Design.**
- **Teamwork & Adaptability:** efficient **communication** within a team towards project completion.
- Bilingual in **English & Italian.**